celebrate and spent the day fasting and in prayer. In 1948 in Delhi he began a fast to the death for peace between the two warring communities. But this had aroused hostility amongst the militant section of the Hindus and on 30 January 1948, one of them shot Gandhi dead.

Gandhi's life of non-violence was perhaps the most remarkable life of the twentieth century, lived as it was during the most violent era in human history, and his influence has spread across the globe – from Martin Luther King to Nelson Mandela to Aung San Suu Kyi. All his life he held to two fundamental principles, *Ahimsa*, non-violence, and *Satya*, truth. He said: 'My uniform experience has convinced me that there is no other God than Truth. And if every page of these chapters does not proclaim to the reader that the only means for the realization of Truth is *Ahimsa*, I shall deem all my labour … to have been in vain'.

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